IDEATION PHASE

Define the Problem Statements

Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow

Date	14-10-2026	**Project Type**	ServiceNow Automation
Maximum Marks	2 Marks	**Document Version**	1.0

1. Customer Problem Statement Framework

A strong problem statement should be written from the customer's point of view. It should identify who is experiencing the problem, what outcome they are trying to achieve, what prevents that outcome, why the obstacle exists, and how the situation affects the customer or the organization.

For Automated Network Request Management, the problem is examined from both the requester perspective and the operational perspective so that the proposed ServiceNow solution addresses the complete request lifecycle rather than only the submission form.

I am…	I'm trying to…	But…	Because…	Which makes me…
Customer / role	Desired outcome	Obstacle	Underlying cause	Impact / feeling

2. Problem Discovery Context

Network-service requests can involve access changes, connectivity requirements, firewall or VPN-related requests, network device services, and other infrastructure activities. These requests often require accurate information, controlled approvals, assignment to the right fulfilment team, and clear communication with the requester.

The proposed project therefore focuses on the process problem: how to transform a network request from a potentially manual and fragmented interaction into a controlled, traceable ServiceNow lifecycle with standardized data, approvals, automation, fulfilment, and notifications.

3. Customer Problem Statements

PS-1 — End User / Requester

I am…	I am an employee or business user requesting a network service.
I'm trying to…	I'm trying to submit the correct network request quickly, provide the required information once, and know the current status of my request.
But…	But network requests may involve complex information, unclear request paths, repeated communication, or limited visibility after submission.
Because…	Because the request process is not always standardized and request information may need to be manually interpreted, routed, or followed up.
Which makes me…	Which makes me feel delayed or uncertain about whether my request has reached the correct team and when it will be completed.

PS-2 — Approver / Manager

I am…	I am a manager, service owner, or authorized approver.
I'm trying to…	I'm trying to review network requests quickly and make an informed approval decision.
But…	But requests may not consistently present the same information or arrive through a predictable approval path.
Because…	Because approval routing and request information can depend on manual coordination.
Which makes me…	Which makes approval slower and increases the effort required to understand and track pending requests.

PS-3 — Network Fulfilment Team

I am…	I am a network engineer or network fulfilment team member.
I'm trying to…	I'm trying to receive complete, actionable requests and fulfil them efficiently.
But…	But incomplete information, manual assignment, repeated clarification, and unstructured requests can interrupt fulfilment work.
Because…	Because request capture, task creation, assignment, and communication may not be connected through one automated lifecycle.
Which makes me…	Which makes me spend time on coordination and data clarification instead of focusing on network fulfilment.

PS-4 — IT Administrator

I am…	I am an IT administrator responsible for the ServiceNow configuration and automation.
I'm trying to…	I'm trying to maintain a reliable, secure, and manageable request process.
But…	But manual process dependencies can increase configuration complexity, support effort, and the number of exceptions that need attention.
Because…	Because request, approval, fulfilment, and notification activities may be distributed across separate manual steps.
Which makes me…	Which makes ongoing maintenance and process monitoring more difficult.

4. Cross-Cutting Root Causes

Root Cause	How it contributes to the problem
Fragmented request entry	Users may not always have one standardized path for different network services.
Inconsistent request data	Missing or unclear information can create clarification cycles.
Manual routing and approvals	Requests can require human coordination before reaching the correct decision-maker or fulfiller.
Disconnected fulfilment steps	Request information, fulfilment tasks, and status communication may not be connected.
Limited lifecycle visibility	Requesters and stakeholders may need to ask for updates instead of seeing meaningful status.
Governance dependency	Network-related activities require controlled access, approvals, and traceability.

5. Impact Chain

Inconsistent request	→	**Manual coordination**	→	**Delayed / less predictable fulfilment**
Incomplete information	→	**Clarification cycles**	→	**Additional effort for network team**
Manual approval routing	→	**Waiting / follow-up**	→	**Longer decision cycle**
Limited status visibility	→	**Repeated status enquiries**	→	**Poor requester experience**

6. Consolidated Problem Statement

End users need a simple and reliable way to raise network-service requests with complete information and clear status visibility, while approvers need consistent information and controlled approval paths, and the network fulfilment team needs structured, actionable work. Manual or fragmented request handling can create incomplete data, routing effort, approval delays, repeated clarification, limited traceability, and additional operational workload. Therefore, the project proposes a ServiceNow-based Automated Network Request Management solution that standardizes request capture through the Service Catalog, validates request information, routes approvals through defined rules, orchestrates fulfilment through Flow Designer, creates structured tasks for the network team, and keeps stakeholders informed through notifications and lifecycle tracking.

7. Problem-to-Solution Boundary

Problem Area	First-Release Response	Not Assumed in First Release
Request submission	Service Catalog + guided form	Every possible network service
Data quality	Mandatory / conditional validation	Fully autonomous infrastructure validation
Approvals	Controlled approval routing	Automatic approval of sensitive changes
Fulfilment	Flow Designer + fulfilment task	Uncontrolled automatic network changes
Communication	ServiceNow/email notifications	All external communication channels
Visibility	Request / task status tracking	Advanced predictive analytics

8. Ideation Outcome

- Primary customer: End user / requester raising a network-service request.
- Operational customers: Approvers, network fulfilment team, and IT administrators.
- Core problem: Network requests require a more standardized, controlled, and traceable lifecycle.
- Major pain points: inconsistent information, manual routing, approval coordination, fulfilment effort, limited visibility, and governance dependency.
- Proposed direction: a ServiceNow workflow that connects Service Catalog, validation, approvals, Flow Designer, fulfilment tasks, notifications, access control, and tracking.

— End of Problem Definition —